

BEFORE THE PHILADELPHIA BOARD OF ETHICS

J. Shane Creamer, Jr. Executive Director Philadelphia Board of Ethics 1515 Arch Street, 18 th Floor Philadelphia, PA 19102 Petitioner vs. Dee Dukes Educational Nominating Panel [REDACTED] [REDACTED] deedukes33@gmail.com Respondent	Matter No.: 2510ET24
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**BRIEF IN SUPPORT OF NOTICE OF ADMINISTRATIVE ENFORCEMENT
PROCEEDING**

Pursuant to Philadelphia Board of Ethics (the “Board”) Regulation No. 2 (“Regulation No. 2”), the Procedures for Administrative Enforcement Proceedings that Supplement Board Regulation No. 2, and the Hearing Officer’s November 20, 2025 Briefing Order, the Executive Director submits the following Brief in Support of Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding (“Brief”).

I. PROPOSED FINDINGS OF FACT

1. Dee Dukes (“Dukes” or “Respondent”) was a member of the Educational Nominating Panel when the Educational Nominating Panel was last convened in 2024. Exhibit A, 2024 Statement of Financial Interests filed by Dee Dukes at A1; Exhibit B, February 1, 2024 Meeting Minutes of the Educational Nominating Panel at B1; *see also* Exhibit C, Dukes’ Response to Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding at C4, ¶¶ 1-3.

2. Respondent filed a Statement of Financial Interests (“City Form”)¹ with the Board for calendar year 2024 on September 25, 2025. Exhibit A, 2024 Statement of Financial Interests filed by Dee Dukes at A1; *see also* Exhibit C, Dukes Response to Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding at C4, ¶ 6.

II. **PROPOSED CONCLUSIONS OF LAW**

3. The Ethics Code (“Code”) requires certain individuals to file a City Form—disclosing certain financial information about the filer for the preceding calendar year—with the Board. Code § 20-610(1).
4. In relevant part, the Code requires “[m]embers and executive directors of boards and commissions that exercise significant powers of government, as determined by the Board of Ethics by regulation” to file a City Form. Code § 20-610(1)(e).
5. The Board has determined by regulation that members of the Educational Nominating Panel must file a City Form when the Educational Nominating Panel is convened. Board Regulation No. 3 (“Regulation No. 3”), ¶ 3.6.
6. An individual who is required to file a City Form must do so by May 1 in any year in which they hold office and by May 1 of the year after they leave such office. Code § 20-610(1); Regulation No. 3, ¶ 3.7(a).
7. The failure to timely file a City Form is a violation of Code Section 20-610(1), which is subject to a civil monetary penalty of \$1,000. Code §§ 20-612(1), 20-1302.
8. The Educational Nominating Panel was last convened in 2024. Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶ 1.

¹ A Statement of Financial Interests filed with the Board pursuant to Philadelphia Code Section 20-610 is also known as the City Form. *See* Philadelphia Board of Ethics, *Financial Disclosure*, <https://www.phila.gov/departments/board-of-ethics/financial-disclosure/> (last visited November 4, 2025).

9. Therefore, the members of the Educational Nominating Panel when it was last convened in 2024 were required to file the City Form by May 1, 2025. Code § 20-610(1); Regulation No. 3, ¶¶ 3.6, 3.7(a).
10. Respondent was required to file a City Form for 2024 by May 1, 2025 because Respondent was a member of the Educational Nominating Panel when the Educational Nominating Panel was last convened in 2024. Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶ 1; Code § 20-610(1); Regulation No. 3, ¶¶ 3.6, 3.7(a).
11. By filing the City Form on September 25, 2025, 147 days after the May 1, 2025 deadline, Respondent violated the Code Section 20-610(1). Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶ 2; Code §§ 20-610(1), 20-612(1), 20-1302; Regulation No. 3, ¶ 3.7(a).
12. Respondent's Code violation is subject to a civil monetary penalty of \$1,000. Code §§ 20-612(1), 20-1302.

III. ARGUMENT

Respondent admits she was a member of the Educational Nominating Panel when it convened in 2024, which obligated Respondent to file a City Form by May 1, 2025. Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶ 1; Code § 20-610(1); Regulation No. 3, ¶¶ 3.6, 3.7(a).² Respondent did not file the City Form with the Board by May 1, 2025. Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶ 2. Accordingly, Respondent violated the Code and is subject to a \$1,000 civil monetary penalty. Code §§ 20-610(1), 20-612(1), 20-1302; Regulation No. 3, ¶ 3.7(a).

² In particular, Regulation No. 3, Paragraph 3.7, Example 4 informs the appropriate disposition of this matter. In Example 4, in part, the members of a nominating panel that is listed in Regulation No. 3, Paragraph 3.6 and was convened in 2021 were required to file a City Form with the Board by May 1, 2022 that disclosed information related to calendar year 2021. Here, the Educational Nominating Panel, which is listed in Regulation No. 3, Paragraph 3.6, was convened in 2024. Therefore, the Panel's members were required to file a City Form by May 1, 2025 that disclosed information related to calendar year 2024.

a. Neither the Code nor Regulation No. 3 contain notice or intent requirements as Respondent claims.

In her Response to Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding, Respondent claims that the “Board must provide proper notice to the individual so as not to prejudice the rights and responsibility of the individual” with respect to the requirement that certain individuals file the City Form. Exhibit C, Dukes’ Response to Notice of Administrative Adjudication at C2. Respondent alleges that she did not receive proper notice of either the requirement to file or the consequences of a failure to file. *Id.* at C2-C4. Additionally, Respondent claims that because she did not receive proper notice of the City Form filing requirement, she did not intentionally fail to timely file the City Form. *Id.* at C3, C4, ¶ 3, C5, ¶ 8. Therefore, Respondent argues that she did not violate Code Section 20-610(1) for failing to timely file the City Form as alleged by the Executive Director. *Id.* at C5, ¶ 8.

For the reasons discussed *infra*, Respondent’s claims fail as a matter of law, as neither the Code nor Regulation No. 3 require the Board to provide notice to individuals of their requirement to file the City Form. In any event, Respondent had an opportunity to file the City Form late without a monetary penalty. Finally, whether the failure to timely file the City Form was done knowingly or intentionally is of no significance as to whether a violation occurred. Respondent does not raise any defenses that impact the Executive Director’s proposed findings and proposed conclusions of law that Respondent was required to file a City Form by May 1, 2025 and did not do so. Accordingly, the Board should find Respondent violated the Code and is subject to a \$1,000 civil monetary penalty. Code §§ 20-610(1), 20-612(1), 20-1302; Regulation No. 3, ¶ 3.7(a).

i. Neither Philadelphia Code Section 20-610 nor Regulation No. 3 require any notice from the Board regarding the obligation to file the City Form.

Code Section 20-610, as interpreted by Regulation No. 3, does not require the Board, who is charged with ensuring compliance and the enforcement of the filing of the City Form, to provide notice to individuals that are required to file. *See generally* Code § 20-610; Regulation No. 3. Rather, it is “the duty of each head of a department, agency, authority, board, and commission to furnish a copy of this ordinance [Code Chapter 20-600 *et al.*] to each and every employee under his or her direction.” Code § 20-611. Therefore, the Board was not required to provide notice to Respondent of her filing requirement, either before or after the May 1, 2025 deadline, as Respondent claims. Accordingly, for the reasons discussed *supra*, the Board should find Respondent violated the Code Section 20-610(1) and is subject to a \$1,000 civil monetary penalty.

ii. Respondent had an opportunity to file the City Form late that would not have resulted in a civil monetary penalty.

Although Board staff was under no legal obligation to inform Respondent of her requirement to file the City Form, Board compliance staff contacted Respondent anyway and gave Respondent an opportunity to file late without the imposition of a penalty. *See generally* Exhibit D, Compliance Correspondence from Investigative Analyst Alexander Kramer to Dee Dukes; Exhibit E, Declaration of Investigative Analyst Alexander Kramer. Board compliance staff contacted Respondent several times after the May 1, 2025 deadline. *Id.* Board compliance staff offered Respondent a time period to cure the deficiency without penalty – specifically, until June 30, 2025, nearly two months after the original due date. Exhibit D, Compliance Correspondence from Investigative Analyst Alexander Kramer to Dee Dukes at D4. To the extent that Respondent argues that she was not aware of a civil monetary penalty associated with the untimely filing of the City Form, Board compliance staff’s June 13, 2025 correspondence specifically mentioned a

civil monetary penalty associated with the failure to file a City Form if the matter was not resolved by the end of the June 30, 2025 curative period. *Id.*

Respondent alleges she did not receive any notice from the Board because the email address that was used by Board staff was one “created for the sole, exclusive, confidential purpose and use in performing the duties required by the Educational Nominating Panel.” Exhibit C, Respondent’s Response to Notice of Administrative Adjudication at C2. Accordingly, Respondent admits that this was an email address she owns and controls arising from her position on the Educational Nominating Panel. *See id.* Whether Respondent checked that email address frequently is irrelevant. Board compliance staff undertook reasonable efforts, in excess of their statutory or regulatory obligations, to inform Respondent that her City Form was overdue but that it could still be filed without penalty.

Even if Respondent did not read any of the above-mentioned correspondence from Board staff, Respondent admits that she was notified of her requirement and failure to file at the end of July 2025. *Id.*³ Respondent’s City Form was not filed for an additional two months after that alleged notification. Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶ 2. This delay is unreasonable in light of the above-described efforts made to alert Respondent of her failure to file. Accordingly, for the reasons discussed *supra*, the Board should find Respondent violated the Code Section 20-610(1) and is subject to a \$1,000 civil monetary penalty.

iii. Respondent’s claimed lack of knowledge or intent is not a valid defense to a Code Section 20-610 violation.

The Code only allows for the base \$1,000 penalty for untimely filing of the City Form to be modified subject to the presence of defined mitigating or aggravating factors. Code §§ 20-

³ Although it is not material, upon information and belief, Respondent actually spoke to a staff member of the Office of the Chief Integrity Officer in July 2025, and not Board Staff as Respondent alleges.

612(1), 20-1302. Intent to violate can be considered an aggravating factor⁴ that warrants an enhanced penalty, but lack of intent is not included as a mitigating factor. Code § 20-1302(b)(1). The Code does not provide an exception to the penalty for failure to timely file a City Form on the grounds of lack of knowledge, nor does it allow the penalty to be waived or reduced for an individual who did not intend to violate.

The Board is not authorized by law to waive the penalty, and here, where the untimeliness of Respondent's filing 147 days after the deadline is not in dispute, the penalty should not be reduced since mitigating factors are absent. The mitigating factors are statutorily defined as: 1) a good faith effort to comply, 2) prompt corrective action, 3) prompt self-reporting, and 4) such other circumstances as may be identified by the Board, by regulation, to warrant a reduced penalty. Code § 20-1302(1)(a)(.1-.4); Regulation No. 3, ¶ 3.19. The Board has not added, by regulation, additional mitigating factors aside from those listed in the Code. *See* Regulation No. 3, ¶ 3.19. Respondent has not proven the presence of any mitigating factors warranting a reduced penalty and Respondent should be subject to the full base \$1,000 penalty. Even if the Board were to make factual findings that mitigating factors were present in this matter, which the Executive Director disputes, the Code definitively states that the Board can only reduce the penalty by \$500 for one mitigating factor, and, at most, \$750 for more than one mitigating factor. Code §20-1302(2)(b). There is no provision, either in the Code or Regulation No. 3, that allows for waiver of the civil monetary penalty in its entirety. *See generally* Code §§ 20-612(1), 20-1302; Regulation No. 3.

The Board should find Respondent violated the Code Section 20-610(1) and is subject to a \$1,000 civil monetary penalty. Respondent was legally obligated to file the City Form by May 1, 2025, and did not file it until September 25, 2025. Proposed Findings of Fact at ¶¶ 1-2; Code § 20-

⁴ The Executive Director does not allege the presence of aggravating factors warranting an enhanced penalty in this matter.

610(1); Regulation No. 3, ¶¶ 3.6, 3.7(a). Respondent's assertions regarding her knowledge and intent of the violation are irrelevant because a failure to file the City Form does not need to be done knowingly or intentionally for a violation to be found and a penalty to be assessed. Code §§ 20-612(1), 20-1302.

Accordingly, for the reasons discussed *supra*, the Board should find Respondent violated the Code Section 20-610(1) and is subject to a \$1,000 civil monetary penalty.

Date: December 1, 2025

Respectfully submitted,

/s J. Shane Creamer, Jr.
J. Shane Creamer, Jr. Esq.
Executive Director

Richard Barzaga, Esq.
Senior Staff Attorney

Erin Ambrose, Esq.
Staff Attorney

City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19102
Phone: (215) 686-9450
Fax: (215) 686-9453

EXHIBIT A

CITY OF PHILADELPHIA

**STATEMENT OF
FINANCIAL INTERESTS**PHILADELPHIA BOARD OF ETHICS
DEPARTMENT OF RECORDS
ROOM 156, CITY HALL
PHILADELPHIA, PA 19107*All Statements of Financial Interests shall
be made available for public inspection
and copying during regular office hours.*

INSTRUCTIONS: Complete the entire form. Type or print in ink. Clearly enter your name in the space provided.
Attach the additional 8-1/2" x 11" sheets if necessary, identifying each item by number.
This form may be completed on line at <https://financial-disclosure.phila.gov>

☐ **AMENDED
STATEMENT**

1. LAST NAME

FIRST NAME

MI

SUFFIX

2. STREET ADDRESS

CITY

STATE

ZIP CODE

CITY DEPARTMENT / AGENCY / COMMISSION / BOARD

Educational Nominating Panel

4. NAME OF PUBLIC POSITION OR PUBLIC OFFICE YOU HOLD/HELD

Board Member (Currently Holding)

5. OCCUPATION OR PROFESSION

REMEMBER:

Items 6 THROUGH 12 - All information concerns the PRIOR CALENDAR YEAR. NO DOLLAR AMOUNTS are required except in Item 9. If answer is NONE, check the box where indicated. Information must be included for the filer only and not family members.

6. REAL ESTATE INTERESTS: List any direct or indirect interest in any real estate as described in attached **Instructions**. If none, check: ☒

ADDRESS

NATURE OF INTEREST

7. CREDITORS: List each loan or debt over \$5,000 and the interest rate thereon as described in the attached Instructions. If none, check: ☐

CREDITOR

ADDRESS

INTEREST RATE

8. DIRECT OR INDIRECT SOURCES OF INCOME: List all sources of \$500 or more in the aggregate as described in the attached Instructions. If City is a source, list City. If none, check: ☐

SOURCE OF INCOME

ADDRESS

9. GIFTS: List sources of gifts with an aggregate value of \$200 or more as described in attached **Instructions**. If none, check: ☒

SOURCE OF GIFT

ADDRESS

VALUE OF GIFT

CIRCUMSTANCES OF GIFT

10. HONORARIA: List sources over \$100 described in attached **Instructions**. If none, check: ☐

SOURCE OF HONORARIUM

ADDRESS OF SOURCE

11. OFFICE, DIRECTORSHIP OR EMPLOYMENT IN ANY BUSINESS ENTITY. If none, check: ☐

BUSINESS

POSITION HELD

12. FINANCIAL INTEREST IN ANY BUSINESS ORGANIZED FOR PROFIT: (See attached **Instructions**.) If none, check: ☐**THIS FORM MUST BE SIGNED AND DATED IN ORDER TO BE ACCEPTED.**

Information represents disclosure for the prior calendar year **2024**. False statements made herein are punishable as authorized by Section 20-612 of the Philadelphia Code and are subject to the penalties prescribed for perjury set forth in 18 Pa. C.S. § 4904.

Signature **COMPLETED AND SIGNED ELECTRONICALLY** Date _____

EXHIBIT B

Educational Nominating Panel
First Public Meeting – February 1, 2024
Official Transcription of Minutes

John Dolan: Recognized a quorum (12 members). Called meeting to order. Briefly introduced the role of the Educational Nominating Panel. Called for introductions of panel members.

Otis Bullock

Bonnie Camarda

William Carter

Dawn Chavous

Robin Cooper

Dee Dukes

Harold Epps

Louis Felton

Atiyah Harmon

Catherine Hicks

Andy Toy

Kimberly Wilson

John Dolan: This meeting is being recorded and will be posted online as required by City ordinance. Your participation in this meeting constitutes consent to being recorded and to having that recording posted online.

John Dolan: First order of business is the adoption of the Rules of Procedure for the Panel. The Rules have been circulated and copies are available to the public on the Educational Nominating Panel's new website.

John Dolan: Called for a panel member to move for the adoption of the Rules of Procedure.

Otis Bullock: I move for the adoption of the Rules of Procedure.

Educational Nominating Panel
First Public Meeting – February 1, 2024
Official Transcription of Minutes

Catherine Hicks: I second the motion.

John Dolan: All those in favor of the adoption of the Rules of Procedure will do so by saying Aye . . . Opposed? Hearing none, rules are adopted.

John Dolan: Introduce topic of election of officers.

Bonnie Camarda: I move for the election of Otis Bullock as Chairperson of the Educational Nominating Panel.

Catherine Hicks: I second that motion.

John Dolan: All those in favor of Otis Bullock as Chairperson of the Educational Nominating Panel will do so by saying Aye . . . Opposed? Hearing none, Otis Bullock is hereby elected the Chairperson of the Educational Nominating Panel.

John Dolan: Recognizes Harold Epps to make a motion.

Harold Epps: I move for the election of Catherine Hicks as Vice Chairperson of the Educational Nominating Panel.

Andy Toy: I second that motion.

John Dolan: All those in favor of Catherine Hicks as Vice Chairperson of the Educational Nominating Panel will do so by saying Aye . . . Opposed? Hearing none, Catherine Hicks is hereby elected the Vice Chairperson of the Educational Nominating Panel.

John Dolan: Recognizes William Carter to make a motion.

William Carter: I move for the election of Andy Toy as Secretary of the Educational Nominating Panel.

Louis Felton: I second that motion.

John Dolan: All those in favor of Andy Toy as Secretary of the Educational Nominating Panel will do so by saying Aye . . . Opposed? Hearing none, Andy Toy is hereby elected the Secretary of the Educational Nominating Panel.

John Dolan: Recognizes Otis Bullock to make a motion.

Educational Nominating Panel
First Public Meeting – February 1, 2024
Official Transcription of Minutes

Otis Bullock: I move for the election of Kimberly Wilson as Assistant Secretary of the Educational Nominating Panel.

Catherine Hicks: I second that motion.

John Dolan: All those in favor of Kimberly Wilson as Assistant Secretary of the Educational Nominating Panel will do so by saying Aye . . . Opposed? Hearing none, Kimberly Wilson is hereby elected the Assistant Secretary of the Educational Nominating Panel.

John Dolan: Invited presentations from administration.

Renee Garcia: Presented the requirements for membership on the Board of Education from Law Department.

Vanessa Garrett Harley: Presented the duties and qualities of Board of Education members from the Office of Children and Families.

John Dolan: Presented the Nominating Panel process and next steps.

John Dolan: I move that the Chair be authorized to open the application period and to cause compliance with Section 12-207(d) of the City Charter, which requires the Panel to invite City organizations and individuals to submit names of qualified people for consideration by the Panel and to take appropriate steps to publicize the invitation and selection process by advertisement as required. The portal will remain open until at least February 16 at 11:59 PM.

Otis Bullock: I second that motion.

John Dolan: All those in favor of opening the application period by saying Aye . . . Opposed? Hearing none the motion is adopted.

[ADJOURNED]

EXHIBIT C

BOARD OF ETHICS OF THE CITY OF PHILADELPHIA

J. Shane Creamer, Jr.	:	
Executive Director	:	
Board of Ethics of the	:	
City of Philadelphia	:	
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor	:	Matter No: 2510ET24
Philadelphia, PA 19102	:	Date Served: October 23, 2025
Petitioner	:	
	:	
v.	:	
	:	
Dee Dukes	:	
Educational Nominating Panel	:	
deedukes33@gmail.com	:	
Respondent	:	

RESPONSE TO NOTICE OF ADMINISTRATIVE ENFORCEMENT PROCEEDING

I, Dee Dukes, (the “Respondent”) submits this written response to the Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding dated October 23, 2025, regarding the Executive Director’s findings that there is probable cause to believe that Respondent, Dee Dukes, violated the City of Philadelphia’s Public Integrity Laws, and served a Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding against Respondent, Dee Dukes.

I. Acknowledgment of Notice and Respondent’s Response

I acknowledge receipt of the above-referenced Notice and understand that the Board has initiated administrative enforcement proceedings concerning the issues identified therein. I also understand that I have the right to respond to the Notice in writing pursuant to the extension dated of November 17, 2025 granted in this matter.

II. Response to Right to Request a Hearing Before the Board

Respondent does not wish to request a hearing before the Board.

III. Response to Waiver of the Right to a Hearing

Respondent does not wish to request a hearing and waives the right to a hearing.

IV. Response to Applicable Provisions of Law Alleged to be Violated

Respondent denies that she violated the Philadelphia Code Section 20-610, specifically Ethics Code Section 20-610(1), as interpreted by Board Regulation No. 3.

A. Response to the Requirement to file a Statement of Financial Interest

Although Section 20-610 of the Ethics Code requires certain individuals to file a Statement of Financial Interests with the Board, the Board must provide proper notice to the individual so as to not prejudice the rights and responsibilities of the individual.

Respondent denies that proper notice was received as the Board used only an email address created for the sole, exclusive and confidential purpose and use in performing the duties required by the Educational Nominating Panel in 2024, and suggested by the Educational Nominating Panel staff to keep all other personal and business matters separate in the event there are public requests made pertaining to the “Right to Know” Law.

At the end of July 2025, Respondent received a cell phone call from the Board of Ethics staff notifying Respondent that a Statement of Financial Interest required by the Philadelphia Code was due. There was no mention during the weeks or months of the convening of the Educational Nominating Panel of the existence of a Financial Disclosure Statement referred to as the City Form that would become due at any time after serving on the Educational Nominating Committee.

In the initial cell phone call to inform Respondent that the City Form was due, Respondent had no knowledge of the existence of said City Form or even that the City Form was late. Respondent inquired about the purpose of said City Form and asked several questions regarding the relevance of completing the City Form.

In the initial telephone call and subsequent telephone calls thereafter, there was no mention of a \$250 penalty filing fee for late submissions. Also, the representative who contacted me, initially, suggested all that was needed was to complete the City Form and submit it.

Respondent stated that she did not have a copy of the required City Form prior to the Board's outreach and, therefore, was unaware of the proper procedure for completing it. Respondent's active email was provided to the Board's staff representative, and eventually Respondent received a digital copy of the City Form. Respondent did not understand how to properly complete the City Form upon receipt.

On September 25, 2025, Respondent obtained assistance to ensure the City Form was completed correctly. With assistance provided by the Board staff representative, Respondent promptly filled out the City Form and electronically submitted the City Form on September 25, 2025. Respondent acted in good faith and took the initiative to complete the City Form when notified in compliance with proper instructions and assistance provided to Respondent.

Respondent denies all allegations of violating Code Section 20-610, and any and all Regulations referred to in paragraph IV, (Applicable provisions of Law alleged to be violated).

B. Response to Penalties for violations

Respondent did not intentionally fail to file a City Form in violation of the Ethics Code. Additionally, Respondent states that timely or proper notice was not provided to her by the Board of Ethics using either her current and active email and/or mailing the requested City Form with a

Notice to File to the Respondent's home address: [REDACTED] by the deadline date of May 1, 2025.

Further, Respondent states that she never received any documents pertaining to the filing of a City Form during and/or after the convening of the Educational Nominating Panel in 2024; and that no notice was received of said failure to file the City Form would result in either a penalty of \$250 or a civil monetary penalty of \$1,000 while performing the duties while serving on the Educational Nominating Panel.

V. Response to Description of the Acts that Form the Basis of the Alleged Violation

A. Background

1. Agreed.
2. Agreed.
3. Denied in part. Respondent was a member of the Educationalal Nominating Panel that last convened in 2024. Respondent was never informed and unaware that a City Form was required to be filed for 2024 by May 1, 2025.

B. Factual Allegations

4. Denied in part. Respondent was never informed and unaware that a City Form for 2024 was to be filed by May 1, 2025.
5. Denied in part. Respondent was contacted by Board Staff after May 1, 2025 deadline.
6. Agreed. Respondent filed a City Form on September 25, 2025 after the May 1, 2025 deadline as a result of Board staff contacting Respondent by telephone.

VI. Response to Alleged Violation: Count I-Violation of Ethics Code Section 20-610(1)

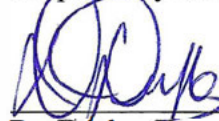
7. Respondent is unclear as to the meaning and understanding of this statement.

8. Denied. Respondent did not intentionally fail to respond to filing a City Form for 2024 by May 1, 2025. Respondent was never informed and unaware that a City Form was required to be filed with the Board of Ethics, and therefore, did not violated the Ethics Code Section 20-610(1) as alleged.

WHEREFORE, Respondent respectfully requests that the Executive Director dismiss this action without penalty resulting from the alleged violation of the Philadelphia Code Section 220-610(1), which Respondent denies in whole.

Date: November 17, 2025

Respectfully submitted,



Deedrick Dukes, Respondent
School District of Philadelphia
Member of the Educational
Nominating Panel in 2024

Copy to: (via email)
J. Shane Creamer, Jr. Esq.
Executive Director

Richard Barzaga, Esq.
Senior Staff Attorney

Erin Ambrose, Esq.
Staff Attorney

City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19102

EXHIBIT D

From: [Alexander Kramer](#)
To: dukes.phillyeducationpanel2024@gmail.com
Cc: [Financial Disclosures](#)
Subject: RE: financial disclosure overdue notice
Date: Thursday, May 22, 2025 4:18:06 PM

Hello Dee,

I'm reaching out regarding my prior email and late notice letter regarding your statement of financial interest that was due May 1st. Our electronic filing system indicates that you have not yet completed your filing. As mentioned in the previous letter attachment, you have 30 days to come into compliance. Please let me know if you have any questions about completing your financial disclosure form within that time frame. Thanks and have a great rest of the day!

Best Regards,

Alex

Alex Kramer

Investigative Analyst
City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
One Parkway Building, 18th Floor
1515 Arch Street
Philadelphia, PA 19102-1504
(P): 215-686-9450
Alexander.Kramer@phila.gov

From: Alexander Kramer
Sent: Thursday, May 8, 2025 1:58 PM
To: 'dukes.phillyeducationpanel2024@gmail.com'
Subject: financial disclosure overdue notice

Hello Dee,

Please see the attached compliance letter concerning City of Philadelphia statement of financial interest.

If you have any questions, please email me. Thanks!

Best Regards,

Alex

Alex Kramer

Investigative Analyst
City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
One Parkway Building, 18th Floor
1515 Arch Street
Philadelphia, PA 19102-1504
(P): 215-686-9450
Alexander.Kramer@phila.gov



CITY OF PHILADELPHIA

BOARD OF ETHICS

ONE PARKWAY BUILDING
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19102
(215) 686-9450

May 8th, 2025

via email

*Dee Dukes
School District Board of Education Nominating Panel*

Re: Statement of Financial Interests Overdue

Dear Dee,

According to the records of the Philadelphia Board of Ethics (the “Board”), you are an individual that is required to file a Statement of Financial Interests, otherwise known as the City Form. Please allow this letter to serve as notice that the Board has not received from you a 2024 Statement of Financial Interests.

Pursuant to Philadelphia Code Chapter 20- 610 and Board Regulation No. 3, an individual who is required to file a Statement of Financial Interests must do so by the first day of May in any year in which they hold office and by the first day of May of the year after they leave such office. As of the date of this letter, you have not filed a Statement of Financial Interests.

You have 30 days to cure this defect. After 30 days, this matter may be referred to the Board’s Enforcement division for appropriate action. If you have already submitted your required filing or have any questions about your requirements under the law governing Statements of Financial Interests, please contact me as soon as possible at Alexander.Kramer@phila.gov or (215) 686-9451.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

/s/ Alex Kramer

Alex Kramer
Investigative Analyst

City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
One Parkway Building, 18th Floor
1515 Arch Street
Philadelphia, PA 19102-1504

From: [Alexander Kramer](#)
To: dukes.phillyeducationpanel2024@gmail.com
Cc: [Financial Disclosures](#)
Subject: financial disclosure final notice
Date: Friday, June 13, 2025 8:05:04 AM
Attachments: [City Form Final Notice Dee Dukes.pdf](#)

Hello Dee,

Please see the attached compliance letter concerning City of Philadelphia statement of financial disclosure.

If you have any questions, please email me. Thanks!

Best Regards,

Alex

Alex Kramer

Investigative Analyst

City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics

One Parkway Building, 18th Floor

1515 Arch Street

Philadelphia, PA 19102-1504

(P): 215-686-9450

Alexander.Kramer@phila.gov



CITY OF PHILADELPHIA

BOARD OF ETHICS

ONE PARKWAY BUILDING
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19102
(215) 686-9450

June 13, 2025

via email only

Re: Follow Up Correspondence - Statement of Financial Interests Overdue

Dear Dee:

Please allow this letter to serve as a follow up to the May 8, 2025 correspondence notifying you that the Board has not received from you a 2024 Statement of Financial Interests. According to the records of the Philadelphia Board of Ethics (the "Board"), you are an individual that is required to file a Statement of Financial Interests, otherwise known as the City Form.

You have until June 30, 2025, to file the overdue Statement of Financial Interests. After June 30, 2025, this matter can only be resolved through the Board's Enforcement division. Please be aware that under Board Regulation No. 3, failure to file a Statement of Financial Interests is subject to up to a \$2,000 civil monetary penalty. Matters referred to the Enforcement division are resolved via public settlement agreement or formal enforcement action.

If you have already submitted your required filing or have any questions about your requirements under the law governing Statements of Financial Interests, please contact me as soon as possible at alexander.kramer@phila.gov

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Sincerely,

/s/ Alex Kramer

Alex Kramer
Investigative Analyst

City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
One Parkway Building, 18th Floor
1515 Arch Street
Philadelphia, PA 19102-1504

(P): 215-686-9450
Alexander.Kramer@phila.gov

EXHIBIT E

DECLARATION

I, Alexander Kramer, state:

1. I am over 18 years of age. I am fully competent to make this declaration and I have personal knowledge of the facts stated in this declaration.
2. I am a Philadelphia resident.
3. I am employed by the City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics (the “Board”) as an Investigative Analyst.
4. In my capacity as an Investigative Analyst, I sent correspondence to Dee Dukes via the email address “dukes.phillyeducationpanel2024@gmail.com” regarding Dee Dukes’ 2024 Statement of Financial Interests.
5. The documents identified as Exhibit D are a true and correct copy of the correspondence described in Paragraph 4.

I, Alexander Kramer, have read the foregoing and verify that the statements made in this declaration are true and correct to the best of my knowledge, information, and belief.

I understand that the statements herein are made subject to the penalties of 18 Pa.C.S. § 4904 (relating to unsworn falsification to authorities).

Date: December 1, 2025

/s Alexander Kramer

Alexander Kramer
Investigative Analyst
City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I certify that a true and correct copy of the above-captioned Brief in Support of Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding was served upon the following as indicated:

By Email and Regular Mail:

Dee Dukes
Educational Nominating Panel

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

deedukes33@gmail.com

By Email:

Louis S. Rulli, Esq.
Hearing Officer
c/o Jordana Greenwald, Esq.
General Counsel
City of Philadelphia Board of Ethics
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19102
BOEGCStaff@phila.gov

Date: December 1, 2025

/s J. Shane Creamer, Jr.
J. Shane Creamer, Jr. Esq.
Executive Director

Richard Barzaga, Esq.
Senior Staff Attorney

Erin Ambrose, Esq.
Staff Attorney



CITY OF PHILADELPHIA

BOARD OF ETHICS

ONE PARKWAY BUILDING
1515 Arch Street, 18th Floor
Philadelphia, PA 19102

December 1, 2025

via email only

Louis S. Rulli, Esq.
Hearing Officer
c/o Jordana Greenwald
General Counsel
Philadelphia Board of Ethics
BOEGCStaff@phila.gov

***Re: Administrative Adjudication Matter #2510ET24
Brief in Support of Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding***

Dear Hearing Officer:

Please find enclosed a Brief in Support of Notice of Administrative Enforcement Proceeding in the above-captioned matter.

Please let me know if you have any questions about the enclosed documents.

Sincerely,

/s Richard Barzaga

Richard Barzaga
Senior Staff Attorney, Enforcement
richard.barzaga@phila.gov

Enclosures

CC: Dee Dukes (via email and regular mail)